

PROGRESSIVE STEPS TO

SYNCO-PATION

FOR THE MODERN DRUMMER

BY
TED REED



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Foreword

In every band or ensemble, the drummer is called upon to give that group a solid rhythmic foundation. Therefore it is important that every drummer have excellent music reading skills. The goal of this book is to first introduce basic music reading skills and then to explore many of the most common syncopation rhythms found in today's music.

Here are some suggestions on how to practice the rhythms and exercises found in this book:

1. Count out loud. This is a "must" in order to become a good reader.
2. Practice at various tempos from slow to fast.
3. Work on incorporating the syncopated rhythms you learn in this book around the full drumset (toms, cymbals, hi-hat, etc.).
4. Devote some of your practice time to playing with a metronome.

Remember, there is no substitute for a good teacher.

Since its publication, many drummers have asked me how I was inspired to write *Progressive Steps to Syncopation for the Modern Drummer*.

I was teaching drums at the Hartnett Music School, located at 1585 Broadway in New York City. I gave 85 half-hour lessons each week and had approximately 55 students (some took two lessons a week). I taught Monday through Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. and 6:00 p.m. to 10:00 p.m. In each half-hour lesson, I would listen to the student's last lesson and then write, demonstrate, explain and play with them on their new lesson. Since I could not find any books on syncopation, each lesson had to be written out individually.

When I would get home at night, my hands and arms would ache as a result of having to do so much writing. It was then that I decided to write the lessons out on manuscript paper. I wrote every night from midnight to 4:00 a.m., until I had a total of 60 pages. I had 200 copies of each page printed, which enabled me to hand whatever page was needed to a student—no more writing out each lesson every time.

I was careful to protect my original work from plagiarism until I received an official copyright from the Bureau of Copyrights in Washington, D.C. I had it published in 1958, and the book has sold very well ever since. Thanks to many teachers and drummers it is now one of the most popular drum books ever written.

Ted Reed

Note-Reading Rhythms/Exercises

Lesson One

Playing quarter notes, quarter rests and half rests.

1 

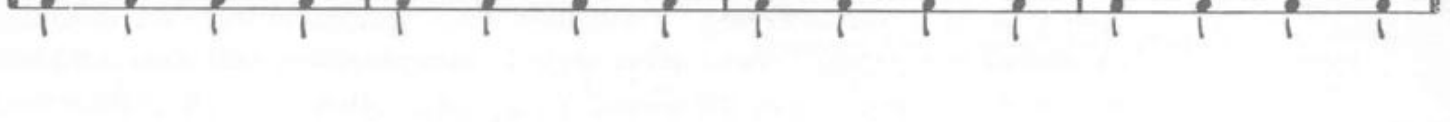
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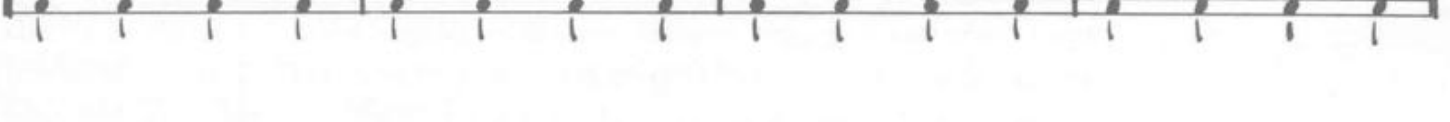
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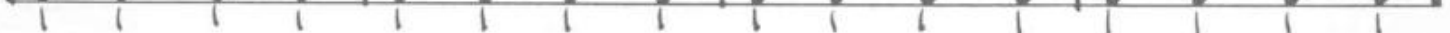
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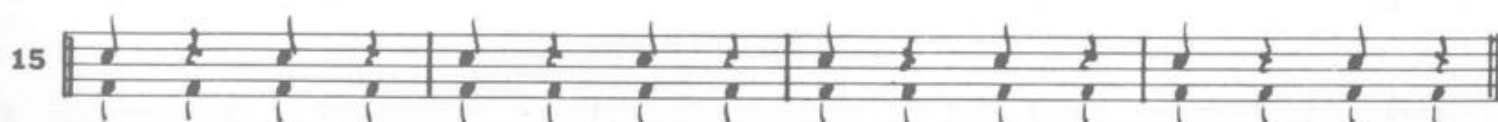
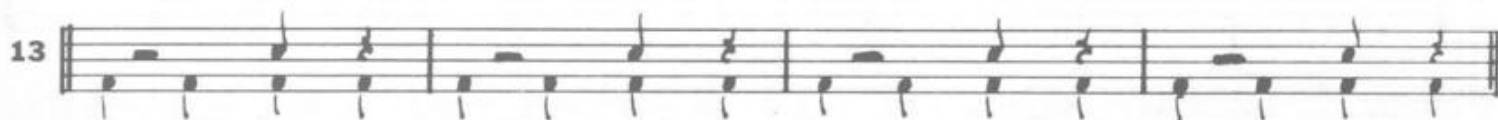
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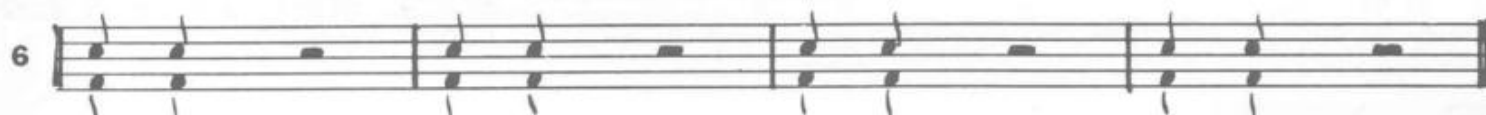


16-Bar Exercise



Lesson Two

Playing quarter notes, quarter rests and half rests in unison.





Lesson Three

Playing quarter notes, quarter rests and half rests independently.

10 exercises for independent playing of quarter notes, quarter rests, and half rests.

Exercise 1: Bass clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: G2, A2, B2, C3; D2, E2, F2, G2; A2, B2, C3, D3; E2, F2, G2, A2.

Exercise 2: Treble clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4; G4, A4, B4, C5; D4, E4, F4, G4; A4, B4, C5, D5.

Exercise 3: Treble clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4; G4, A4, B4, C5; D4, E4, F4, G4; A4, B4, C5, D5.

Exercise 4: Treble clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4; G4, A4, B4, C5; D4, E4, F4, G4; A4, B4, C5, D5.

Exercise 5: Treble clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4; G4, A4, B4, C5; D4, E4, F4, G4; A4, B4, C5, D5.

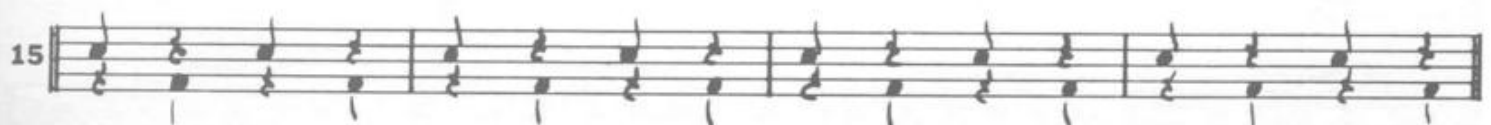
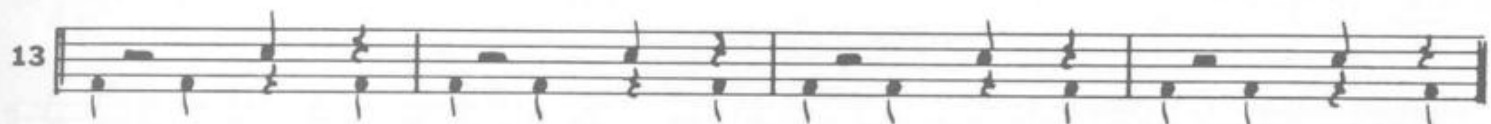
Exercise 6: Treble clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4; G4, A4, B4, C5; D4, E4, F4, G4; A4, B4, C5, D5.

Exercise 7: Treble clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4; G4, A4, B4, C5; D4, E4, F4, G4; A4, B4, C5, D5.

Exercise 8: Treble clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4; G4, A4, B4, C5; D4, E4, F4, G4; A4, B4, C5, D5.

Exercise 9: Treble clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4; G4, A4, B4, C5; D4, E4, F4, G4; A4, B4, C5, D5.

Exercise 10: Treble clef, common time (C). Four measures of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4; G4, A4, B4, C5; D4, E4, F4, G4; A4, B4, C5, D5.



16-Bar Exercise



Lesson Four

Playing eighth notes and quarter notes.

10 exercises for playing eighth notes and quarter notes on a five-line staff. Each exercise consists of four measures, with a double bar line at the end. The exercises are numbered 1 through 10 on the left side of the staff.

Exercise 1: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

Exercise 2: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

Exercise 3: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

Exercise 4: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

Exercise 5: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

Exercise 6: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

Exercise 7: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

Exercise 8: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

Exercise 9: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

Exercise 10: Treble clef, C major key signature, common time (C). The melody consists of eighth notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2, C3, F2.

11 

12 

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15 

20-Bar Exercise











Lesson Five

Playing dotted eighth/sixteenth notes and quarter notes.

10 exercises for playing dotted eighth/sixteenth notes and quarter notes.

Exercise 1: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (C4-D4, D4-E4, E4-F4, F4-G4) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

Exercise 2: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

Exercise 3: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (B4-A4, A4-G4, G4-F4, F4-E4) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

Exercise 4: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (D4-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

Exercise 5: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (F4-E4, E4-D4, D4-C4, C4-B3) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

Exercise 6: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3, F3-E3) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

Exercise 7: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (E3-D3, D3-C3, C3-B2, B2-A2) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

Exercise 8: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (A2-G2, G2-F2, F2-E2, E2-D2) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

Exercise 9: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (D2-C2, C2-B1, B1-A1, A1-G1) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

Exercise 10: Treble clef, C major, 4/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (F2-E2, E2-D2, D2-C2, C2-B1) with a dotted eighth note and a sixteenth note. Bass line: C4, C4, C4, C4.

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20-Bar Exercise











Lesson Six

Playing eighth-note triplets and quarter notes.

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16-Bar Exercise









Lesson Seven

Playing eighth-note triplets, eighth notes and quarter notes.

The image displays ten staves of musical notation, numbered 1 through 10 on the left. Each staff contains four measures of music. The notation is as follows:

- Staff 1:** Treble clef, 4/4 time signature. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the first system has a whole note on G3.
- Staff 2:** Treble clef. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the second system has a whole note on G3.
- Staff 3:** Treble clef. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the third system has a whole note on G3.
- Staff 4:** Treble clef. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the fourth system has a whole note on G3.
- Staff 5:** Treble clef. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the fifth system has a whole note on G3.
- Staff 6:** Treble clef. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the sixth system has a whole note on G3.
- Staff 7:** Treble clef. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the seventh system has a whole note on G3.
- Staff 8:** Treble clef. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the eighth system has a whole note on G3.
- Staff 9:** Treble clef. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the ninth system has a whole note on G3.
- Staff 10:** Treble clef. Each measure contains a quarter note on G4, followed by an eighth-note triplet on A4, B4, and C5. The bottom staff of the tenth system has a whole note on G3.

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15 

16-Bar Exercise



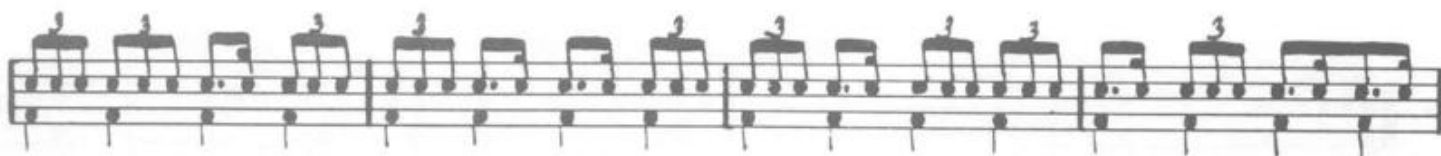
Lesson Eight

Playing eighth-note triplets and dotted eighth/sixteenth notes.

The image displays ten staves of musical notation, numbered 1 through 10 on the left. Each staff is in 4/4 time, indicated by a '4' over a '4' in the first staff. The notation consists of eighth-note triplets and dotted eighth/sixteenth notes. The triplets are marked with a '3' above the notes. The dotted eighth/sixteenth notes are marked with a dot above the eighth note. The staves are arranged in a single column, and each staff contains four measures of music. The notes are primarily eighth notes, with some sixteenth notes appearing in the triplets. The overall pattern is a rhythmic exercise designed to practice these specific note values and groupings.



16-Bar Exercise



Lesson Nine

Playing sixteenth notes and quarter notes.

10 exercises for playing sixteenth notes and quarter notes, numbered 1 through 10. Each exercise is written on a five-line staff with a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature. The exercises progress from simple quarter notes to complex sixteenth-note patterns.

Exercise 1: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 2: A quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 3: A quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 4: A quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 5: A quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

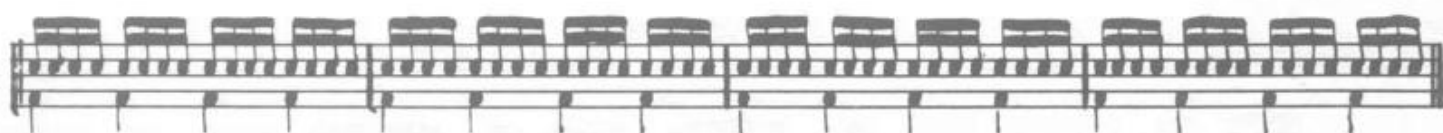
Exercise 6: A quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 7: A quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 8: A quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 9: A quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 10: A quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on B4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on C5, followed by a quarter rest.

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15 

20-Bar Exercise



Lesson Ten

Playing sixteenth notes and eighth notes.

10 exercises for playing sixteenth and eighth notes.

Exercise 1: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

Exercise 2: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

Exercise 3: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

Exercise 4: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

Exercise 5: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

Exercise 6: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

Exercise 7: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

Exercise 8: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

Exercise 9: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

Exercise 10: Treble clef, 6/4 time. Four measures of eighth-note pairs (G4-A4, A4-B4, B4-C5, C5-B4, B4-A4, A4-G4) and eighth-note pairs (F3-G3, G3-A3, A3-B3, B3-C4, C4-B3, B3-A3, A3-G3, G3-F3).

The musical score for 'The Rose Tree' is presented in five systems, numbered 11 through 15. Each system consists of two staves. The upper staff of each system contains a melody with various note values, including eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together. The lower staff contains a bass line with simpler note values, primarily quarter and eighth notes. The music is written in a common time signature, indicated by a 'C' at the beginning of the first system. The notation is clear and legible, with a focus on the rhythmic and melodic structure of the piece.

20-Bar Exercise

A handwritten musical score for the song "The Rose Tree". The score is written on five systems, each consisting of a treble staff and a bass staff. The time signature is 9/4, indicated at the beginning of the first system. The music is written in a simple, handwritten style with various note values, rests, and bar lines. The melody is primarily in the treble staff, while the bass staff provides a harmonic accompaniment. The piece concludes with a double bar line and a final note in the treble staff.

Lesson Eleven

Playing sixteenth notes and eighth notes.

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6 

7 

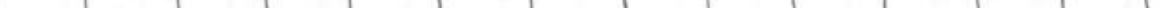
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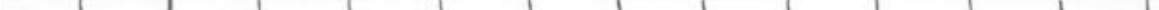
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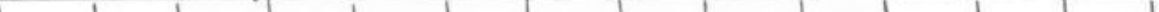




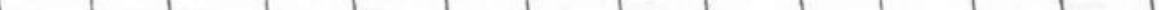
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36 

40-Bar Exercise

This musical exercise is written in 7/8 time, indicated by the '7' over a 'C' time signature. It consists of ten systems, each with a treble and bass staff. The bass line is a steady eighth-note pulse. The treble staff contains a melodic line primarily composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, with occasional triplets and rests. The exercise concludes with a double bar line and a repeat sign.

48-Bar Exercise

This musical score is a 48-bar exercise in bass clef, common time (C). It is written on a grand staff with two staves. The exercise is divided into four 12-bar phrases. The first phrase (bars 1-12) begins with a bass clef and a common time signature. The second phrase (bars 13-24) continues the pattern. The third phrase (bars 25-36) includes a repeat sign at the beginning. The fourth phrase (bars 37-48) concludes the exercise with a double bar line. The notation features a variety of rhythmic patterns, including eighth and sixteenth notes, and rests, all set against a steady bass line.

Lesson Twelve

Playing eighth notes, eighth rests and quarter notes. *corchees s/y c/swing*

12 exercises for playing eighth notes, eighth rests, and quarter notes. Each exercise is written on a grand staff (treble and bass clefs) in 4/4 time. The exercises are numbered 1 through 12.

The exercises are as follows:

- Exercise 1: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter rest, eighth note G4, quarter note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 2: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 3: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 4: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 5: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 6: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 7: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 8: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 9: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 10: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 11: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.
- Exercise 12: Treble clef, 4/4 time. Pattern: Quarter note G4, eighth note F4, eighth note E4, quarter note D4. Repeated 4 times.

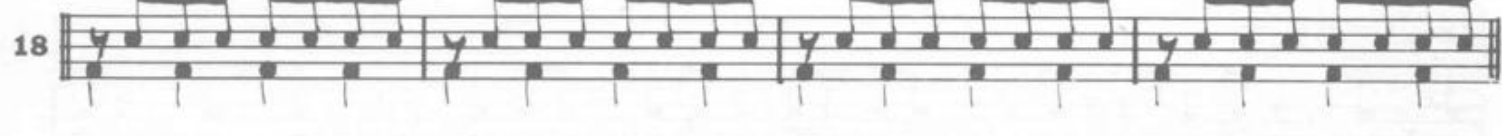
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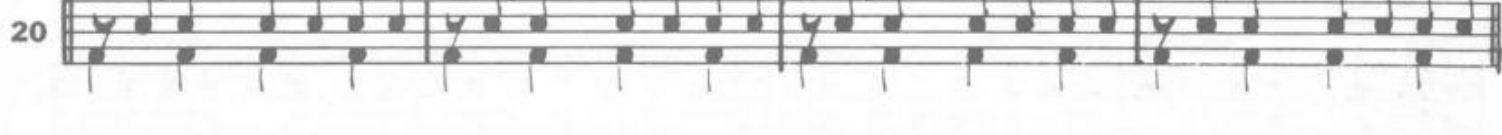
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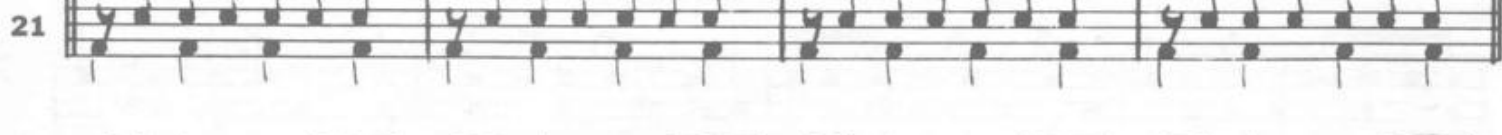
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48-Bar Exercise



Syncopation

Syncopation Set 1

Syncopation occurs when a temporary displacement of the regular metrical accent occurs, causing the emphasis to shift from a strong accent to a weak accent.

In the examples below, each pattern (A, B and C) sounds the same, yet is written differently.

1 (A) 1+ 2 3 4 (B) 1+ 2+ 3 4 (C) 1+2+ 3 4

2 1 2+ 3+ 4 1 2+ 3+ 4 1 2+3+ 4

3 1 2 3+ 4+ 1 2 3+ 4+ 1 2 3+4+

4 1+ 2+ 3+ 4+ 1+ 2+ 3+ 4+ 1+2+ 3+4+

5 1+ 2+ 3+ 4+ 1+ 2+ 3+ 4+ 1+2+ 3+4+

6 1+ 2+ 3 4 1+ 2+ 3 4 1+2+ 3 4

7 1 2+ 3+ 4 1 2+ 3+ 4 1 2+3+ 4

8 1 2 3+ 4+ 1 2 3+ 4+ 1 2 3+4+

9 1+ 2 3+ 4 1+ 2+ 3+ 4+ 1+2+ 3+4+

10 1+ 2+ 3+ 4 1+ 2+ 3+ 4+ 1+2+ 3+4+

11 1+ 2 3 4 1+ 2+ 3 4 1+2+ 3 4

12 1 2 3+ 4 1 2 3+ 4+ 1 2 3+4+

Syncopation Set 2

The following 48 exercises begin with the 12 rhythms found in Set 1 with new rhythms gradually introduced.

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This musical score page contains measures 25 through 36. The notation is written on a grand staff (treble and bass clefs) with a 4/4 time signature. The music is characterized by a steady eighth-note accompaniment in the bass clef and a melody in the treble clef. The melody consists of eighth-note patterns, often with beamed eighth notes and occasional ties. The key signature is one flat (B-flat). The measures are numbered 25 through 36 on the left side of the page.

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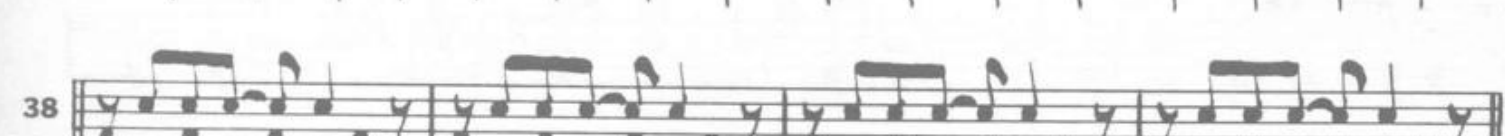
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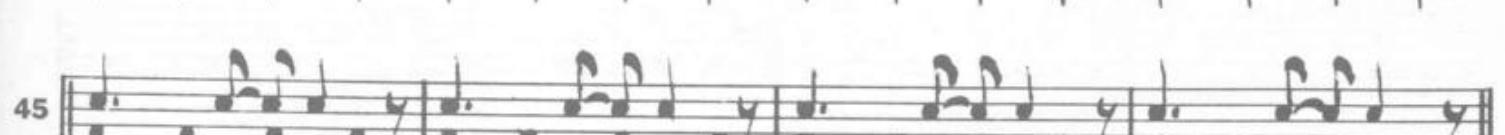
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48 

Exercise One

This musical exercise is written for a single melodic line on a single staff, using a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature. The key signature is one flat (B-flat). The exercise consists of ten staves of music, each containing four measures. The notation includes a variety of rhythmic patterns and intervals, such as eighth notes, quarter notes, and half notes, often beamed together. The exercise is designed to develop technical skills in rhythm and interval training.

Staff 1: Bb^4 A^4 G^4 F^4 | E^4 D^4 C^4 Bb^3 | A^3 G^3 F^3 E^3 | D^3 C^3 Bb^2 A^2

Staff 2: G^4 F^4 E^4 D^4 | C^4 Bb^3 A^3 G^3 | F^3 E^3 D^3 C^3 | Bb^2 A^2 G^2 F^2

Staff 3: E^4 D^4 C^4 Bb^3 | A^3 G^3 F^3 E^3 | D^3 C^3 Bb^2 A^2 | G^2 F^2 E^2 D^2

Staff 4: F^4 E^4 D^4 C^4 | Bb^3 A^3 G^3 F^3 | E^3 D^3 C^3 Bb^2 | A^2 G^2 F^2 E^2

Staff 5: D^4 C^4 Bb^3 A^3 | G^3 F^3 E^3 D^3 | C^3 Bb^2 A^2 G^2 | F^2 E^2 D^2 C^2

Staff 6: C^4 Bb^3 A^3 G^3 | F^3 E^3 D^3 C^3 | Bb^2 A^2 G^2 F^2 | E^2 D^2 C^2 Bb^1

Staff 7: Bb^3 A^3 G^3 F^3 | E^3 D^3 C^3 Bb^2 | A^2 G^2 F^2 E^2 | D^2 C^2 Bb^1 A^1

Staff 8: A^3 G^3 F^3 E^3 | D^3 C^3 Bb^2 A^2 | G^2 F^2 E^2 D^2 | C^2 Bb^1 A^1 G^1

Staff 9: G^3 F^3 E^3 D^3 | C^3 Bb^2 A^2 G^2 | F^2 E^2 D^2 C^2 | Bb^1 A^1 G^1 F^1

Staff 10: F^3 E^3 D^3 C^3 | Bb^2 A^2 G^2 F^2 | E^2 D^2 C^2 Bb^1 | A^1 G^1 F^1 E^1

Exercise Two

Exercise Two is a musical score consisting of ten staves of music, written in 4/4 time. The notation is primarily in bass clef, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The music is characterized by a steady, rhythmic pattern of eighth and sixteenth notes, often grouped in pairs or fours. The first staff begins with a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature, followed by a bass clef. The subsequent staves continue the melodic and harmonic development, featuring various rhythmic figures and rests. The piece concludes with a final double bar line on the tenth staff.

Exercise Three

A handwritten musical score for the song "The Rose Tree". The score is written on ten staves, with the first staff featuring a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature. The music is composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups, and includes various rests. The notation is in a clear, handwritten style, typical of a personal manuscript. The piece concludes with a double bar line on the final staff.

Exercise Four

Exercise Four is a musical score consisting of ten staves of music. The notation is written in 4/4 time, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The music is primarily composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups. The first staff begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one flat. The subsequent staves continue the melodic and harmonic development, featuring various rhythmic patterns and phrasing. The score concludes with a double bar line on the final staff.

Exercise Five

Exercise Five is a musical score consisting of ten staves of music, written in 4/4 time. The notation is primarily in bass clef, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The music is composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups, and includes various rests and ties. The first staff begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one flat, indicating the key of B-flat major or F minor. The subsequent staves continue the melodic and harmonic development, featuring a variety of rhythmic patterns and phrasing. The piece concludes with a double bar line on the final staff.

Exercise Six



Exercise Seven

This musical score, titled "Exercise Seven", is written for a single melodic line on a single staff. The time signature is 7/8, indicated by a '7' over a 'C' (common time) at the beginning of the first staff. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), indicated by a flat symbol on the B line of the staff. The exercise consists of ten staves of music, each containing four measures. The notation includes various rhythmic values: eighth notes, quarter notes, and half notes. The melody is characterized by frequent eighth-note patterns, often beamed together, and occasional quarter and half notes. The exercise concludes with a double bar line and repeat dots at the end of the tenth staff.

Exercise Eight



Exercise Nine

This musical score, titled "Exercise Nine", is written for a single melodic line in 4/4 time. The piece consists of 12 staves of music. The notation is characterized by frequent use of triplets (indicated by a '3' over a group of notes) and accents (indicated by a '>' symbol above a note). The melody is primarily composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 4/4. The exercise concludes with a final cadence on the twelfth staff, marked with a double bar line and repeat dots.

Lesson One

Accented eighth notes.

For variety, the *accented notes* on pages 47–63 may be played on the small tom-tom, large tom-tom, cymbals, etc. They may also be used for accented roll studies by buzzing each note. For example:



12 staves of musical notation, numbered 1 through 12, showing accented eighth notes. Each staff contains a sequence of accented eighth notes, typically grouped in pairs (eighth and sixteenth notes), demonstrating the exercise pattern.

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This image shows a page of musical notation, numbered 48 in the top left corner. It contains 12 staves of music, numbered 13 through 24 on the left side. Each staff is a grand staff with a treble and bass clef. The music is written in a rhythmic pattern of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups of four. Above many of the notes, there are small, stylized symbols that look like question marks or the number '2'. The notation is consistent across all staves, suggesting a repetitive exercise or a single melodic line. The page is clean and well-organized, with clear staff lines and legible notation.

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28-Bar Exercise



Lesson Two

Accented dotted-eighth/sixteenth notes.

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This musical score consists of 12 staves, numbered 12 through 23. Each staff contains a sequence of musical notes, primarily eighth and sixteenth notes, with various ornaments and rests. The notation is consistent across all staves, suggesting a single melodic line or a specific instrumental part. The staves are arranged vertically, with the number 12 at the top left and 23 at the bottom left. The musical notation includes stems, beams, and various note heads, with some notes having small 'v' marks above them, possibly indicating ornaments or specific articulation. The staves are separated by small gaps, and the overall layout is clean and professional.

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28-Bar Exercise

Lesson Three

Accented eighth-note triplets.

This page contains ten staves of musical notation, numbered 1 through 10. Each staff is in 6/4 time and features a series of accented eighth-note triplets. The triplets are written on the upper staff of each system, while the lower staff contains a steady bass line of quarter notes. The triplets are grouped into four measures per staff, with each measure containing two triplets. The notes in the triplets are eighth notes, and the accents are indicated by a wedge-shaped symbol (>) above each note. The bass line consists of quarter notes, with the first note of each measure being a half note (two quarter notes) and the remaining three notes being quarter notes. The notes in the bass line are: Staff 1: G2, A2, B2, C3; Staff 2: A2, B2, C3, D3; Staff 3: B2, C3, D3, E3; Staff 4: C3, D3, E3, F3; Staff 5: D3, E3, F3, G3; Staff 6: E3, F3, G3, A3; Staff 7: F3, G3, A3, B3; Staff 8: G3, A3, B3, C4; Staff 9: A3, B3, C4, D4; Staff 10: B3, C4, D4, E4.



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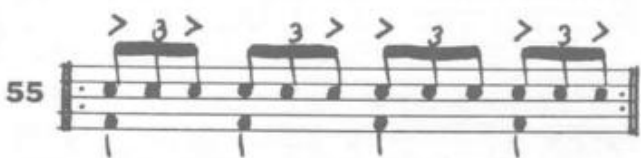
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36-Bar Exercise

This musical exercise is written in 2/4 time and consists of 36 measures, organized into nine systems of four measures each. The melody is composed of eighth notes, with many measures containing triplets of eighth notes. Accents are placed above the first note of each triplet. The exercise is designed to be played over a steady bass line of quarter notes, which is not explicitly written but implied by the structure of the exercise. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 2/4.

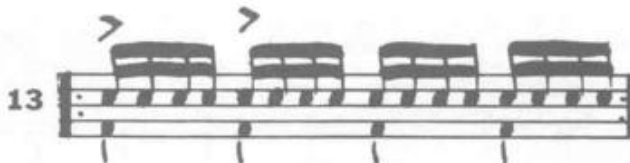
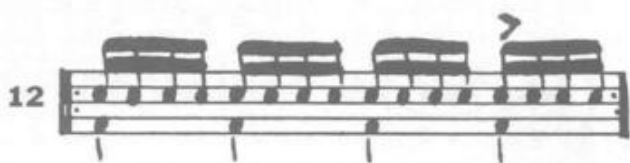
Lesson Four

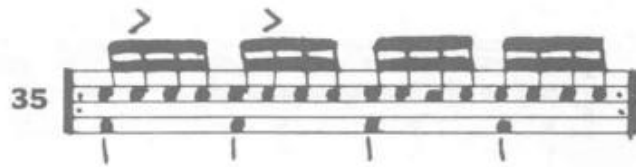
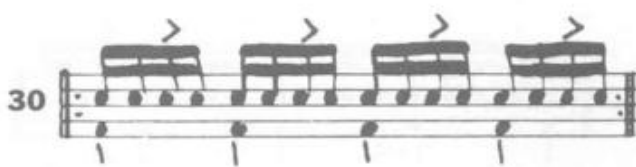
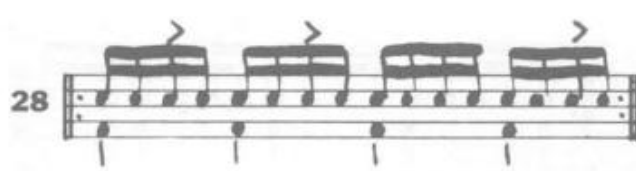
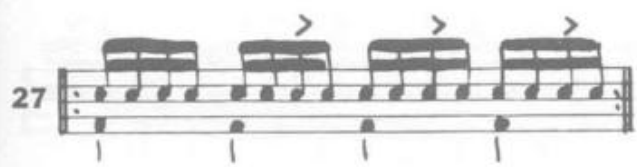
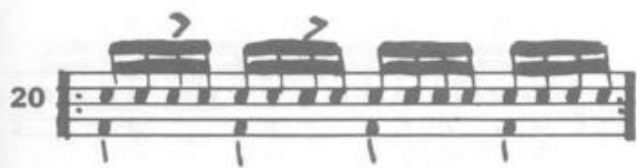
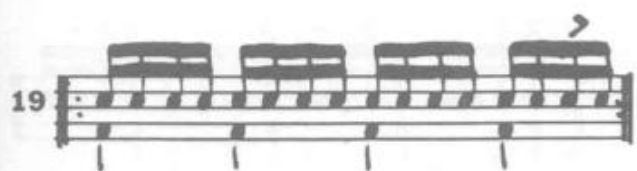
Triplets with mixed sticking.

12 staves of musical notation, each containing a sequence of 12 triplet eighth notes. The triplets are arranged in a 4-measure phrase across 12 staves. The sticking pattern for each triplet is indicated by 'R' (Right) and 'L' (Left) below the notes. The patterns vary across the staves, including sequences like RRL, RLL, LRL, and LRR, as well as more complex mixed patterns like RRLRL, RLLRL, LRLRL, and LRRRL. The exercise is designed to practice mixed sticking techniques for triplets.

Lesson Five

Accented sixteenth notes.





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The first system of musical notation for 'The Little Boat' consists of a treble and bass staff. The treble staff contains four measures of music, each starting with a greater-than sign (>) above the first note. The notes are: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), and C5 (quarter). The bass staff contains four measures of whole notes: G3, F3, E3, and D3. The system ends with a double bar line.

46 

Diagram of a four-bar linkage mechanism. It consists of four cranks (labeled 1, 2, 3, 4) and a connecting rod (labeled 5). The cranks are connected to the connecting rod, which is shown in a horizontal position. The number 48 is visible on the left side of the diagram.

49 

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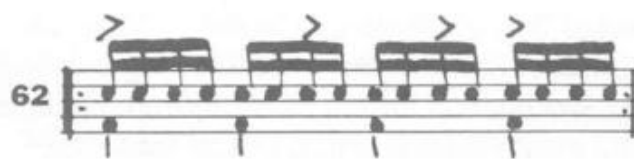
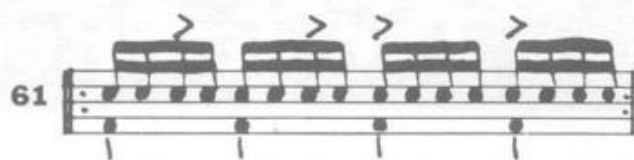
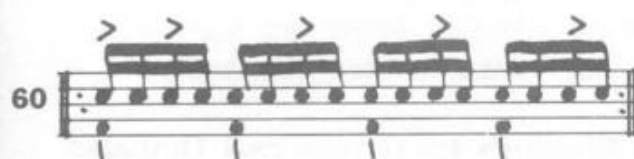
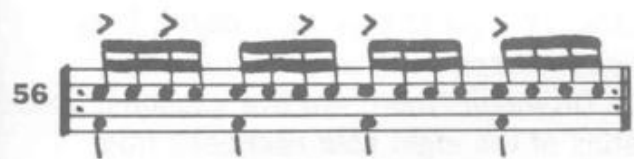
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Musical notation for the first system of 'The Little Boat'. It features a treble and bass staff with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The melody is written in the treble staff, and the bass line is in the bass staff. The melody consists of four measures, each containing a half note and a quarter note. The notes are G4, A4, Bb4, and A4. The bass line consists of four measures, each containing a half note and a quarter note. The notes are F4, E4, D4, and C4. The first measure has an accent (>) over the G4 note. The second measure has an accent (>) over the A4 note. The third measure has an accent (>) over the Bb4 note. The fourth measure has an accent (>) over the A4 note.



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MODERN DRUMMER

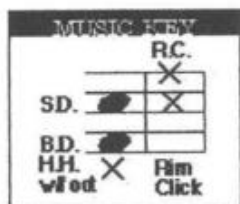
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Jazz Drummers' Workshop

Four-Way Coordination: As Taught By Alan Dawson

by John Ramsay



Alan Dawson had more than forty ways of interpreting the eight pages of syncopated exercises in Ted Reed's Progressive Steps To Syncopation For The Modern Drummer (pages 38-45, new version). This article offers a selection of those examples. (The first three are a prerequisite for learning the rest.)

While playing these exercises, it's important that you do not stop or go back if you make a mistake; Alan was adamant about this. Rather, try to make a mental note of where the mistakes occurred, go back after you've completed the page, isolate the measure or measures, and then play them repeatedly. First, play the measure alone, and then as a repeated two- or four-bar phrase. This approach is essential for establishing good reading habits.

Following are ten ways Alan used Ted Reed's book. Each approach is demonstrated using one or two examples from the book. Spend at least a week on each approach, using the entire syncopation section of the Reed book, before moving on to the next approach.

1. Snare Drum Plays The Line

In this approach, the left hand plays the syncopated line on the snare, the right hand plays jazz time, the bass drum "feathers" (plays lightly) quarter notes, and the hi-hat plays beats

2 and 4.

Written:



Played:



2. Bass Drum Plays The Line

This time the bass drum plays the melody line, the right hand plays time, the left plays rimclicks on beats 2 and 4, and the hi-hat plays 2 and 4.

Written:



Played:



3. Short And Long

In this approach the short notes (8ths) are played on the snare, and the long notes (tied 8ths, quarters, dotted quarters) are played on the bass drum. Play jazz time on the ride cymbal with your right hand and 2 and 4 on the hi-hat.

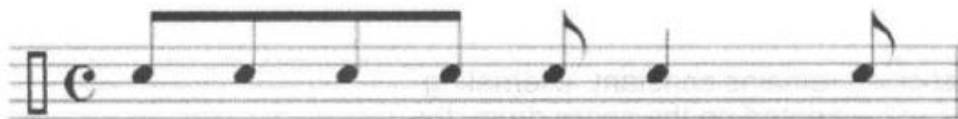
Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:



4. Left Hand Fills In Triplets

This is the first of several exercises that use the idea of filling in triplets. In this example the short notes are played by the right hand on the small tom, and the long notes are played on the cymbal (by the right hand) and the bass drum in unison. The left hand fills in triplets on the snare drum and the hi-hat plays on 2 and 4.

Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:



5. Alternating Triplets

With this approach, the sticking remains constant: alternating RLRLRL. The short notes are accented on the snare drum, the long notes are on the cymbals/bass drum, with the hi-hat again on 2 and 4. The key to making this one sound good lies in playing the unaccented notes on the snare drum close to the drumhead so that the accented notes stand out.

Practice tip: You may want to play all of the notes (accented and unaccented) on the snare to get comfortable with which hand they fall on; then follow the short and long assignments.

Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:

Musical notation for a drum pattern in 4/4 time. The notation consists of a single staff with a common time signature 'C'. The pattern is as follows:

- Measure 1: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 2: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).
- Measure 3: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 4: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).

 Above the staff, there are triplet markings (a '3' with a bracket) over measures 1, 2, 3, and 4. Each triplet is accented with a '>' symbol. Below the staff, the drum parts are indicated by letters: R, L, R, L, R, L, R, L, R, L, R, L.

6. Triplet Roll

This is similar to the alternating triplets, in that the sound sources are the same. Short notes are accented on the snare drum, long notes are on the cymbals/bass drum, and the hi-hat is on 2 and 4.

Written:

Musical notation for the written triplet roll pattern in 4/4 time. The notation consists of a single staff with a common time signature 'C'. The pattern is as follows:

- Measure 1: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 2: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).
- Measure 3: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 4: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).

Played:

Musical notation for the played triplet roll pattern in 4/4 time. The notation consists of a single staff with a common time signature 'C'. The pattern is as follows:

- Measure 1: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 2: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).
- Measure 3: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 4: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).

 Above the staff, there are triplet markings (a '3' with a bracket) over measures 1, 2, 3, and 4. Each triplet is accented with a '>' symbol. Below the staff, the drum parts are indicated by letters: R, LLR, LLRRL, R, LLRRL, RRLL.

Written (consecutive 8ths example):

Musical notation for the written consecutive 8ths example in 4/4 time. The notation consists of a single staff with a common time signature 'C'. The pattern is as follows:

- Measure 1: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 2: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).
- Measure 3: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 4: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).

Played:

Musical notation for the played consecutive 8ths example in 4/4 time. The notation consists of a single staff with a common time signature 'C'. The pattern is as follows:

- Measure 1: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 2: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).
- Measure 3: Quarter note (R), eighth note (L), quarter note (R), eighth note (L).
- Measure 4: Quarter note (L), eighth note (R), quarter note (L), eighth note (R).

 Above the staff, there are triplet markings (a '3' with a bracket) over measures 1, 2, 3, and 4. Each triplet is accented with a '>' symbol. Below the staff, the drum parts are indicated by letters: R, LLR, L, RRL, R, LLR, LLRRL.

7. Bass Drum Plays The Line, Left Hand Fills In

In this example the bass drum plays the melody line while the left hand fills in triplets on the snare drum. The right hand plays the jazz ride pattern on the cymbal, and the hi-hat plays 2 and 4. Be sure to get a good blend among all the voices of the drumset.

Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



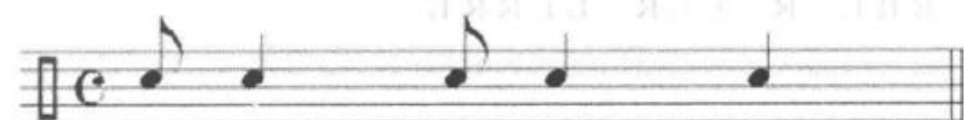
Played:



8. Hi-Hat Plays The Line, Left Hand Fills In

In this example the hi-hat (left foot) plays the melody line and the left hand fills in triplets on the snare drum. Just like in the last example, the right hand plays the ride pattern on the cymbal, but this time there's no bass drum. Be sure to get a good blend between the hi-hat and the snare drum; keep the snare drum strokes low and the notes soft.

Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:



9. Hi-Hat Short, Bass Drum Long, Left Hand Fills

In this example, the hi-hat plays the short notes while the bass drum plays the long notes. The left hand fills in triplets on the snare drum, and the right hand plays the jazz ride pattern. This example is truly a four-way coordination challenge. Be sure to get a good blend of all the parts. You should be able to clearly hear the melody line.

Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):

Played:



Played:



10. Snare Drum Plays The Line, Bass Drum Fills In

This exercise is another challenge. The snare drum plays the melody line, the right hand plays time, the hi-hat plays 2 and 4, and the bass drum fills in triplets (the way the left hand does with exercise 1). I suggest using heel-down technique in order to more easily allow the beater to rebound.

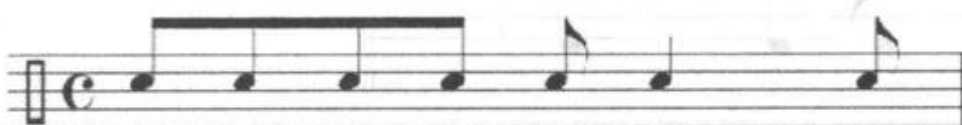
Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:



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11. 4 And 3 on Bass Drum, 2 and 4 on Snare Drum